Vistry Group

Parcels R6 & R7
South Marston
Swindon

Design Compliance Statement

October 2024

Contents

1 Introduction 4

2 Regulating Documents 5

3 Design Parameters 6

Land Use 7
Access & Movement 8
Density 11
Building Heights 12
Frontages 13
Character Ares & Key Spaces 14

4 Detailed Design Response 16

Appearance 18
Materials 19
Access, Street Design & Parking 20
Recycling & Refuse 21
Safety & Security 21
Inclusiveness & Adaptability 22

5 Conclusion 23

Stantec, 101 Victoria Street, Bristol, BS1 6PU

Tel: 0117 929 9677 **Email:** rosina.martin@stantec.com

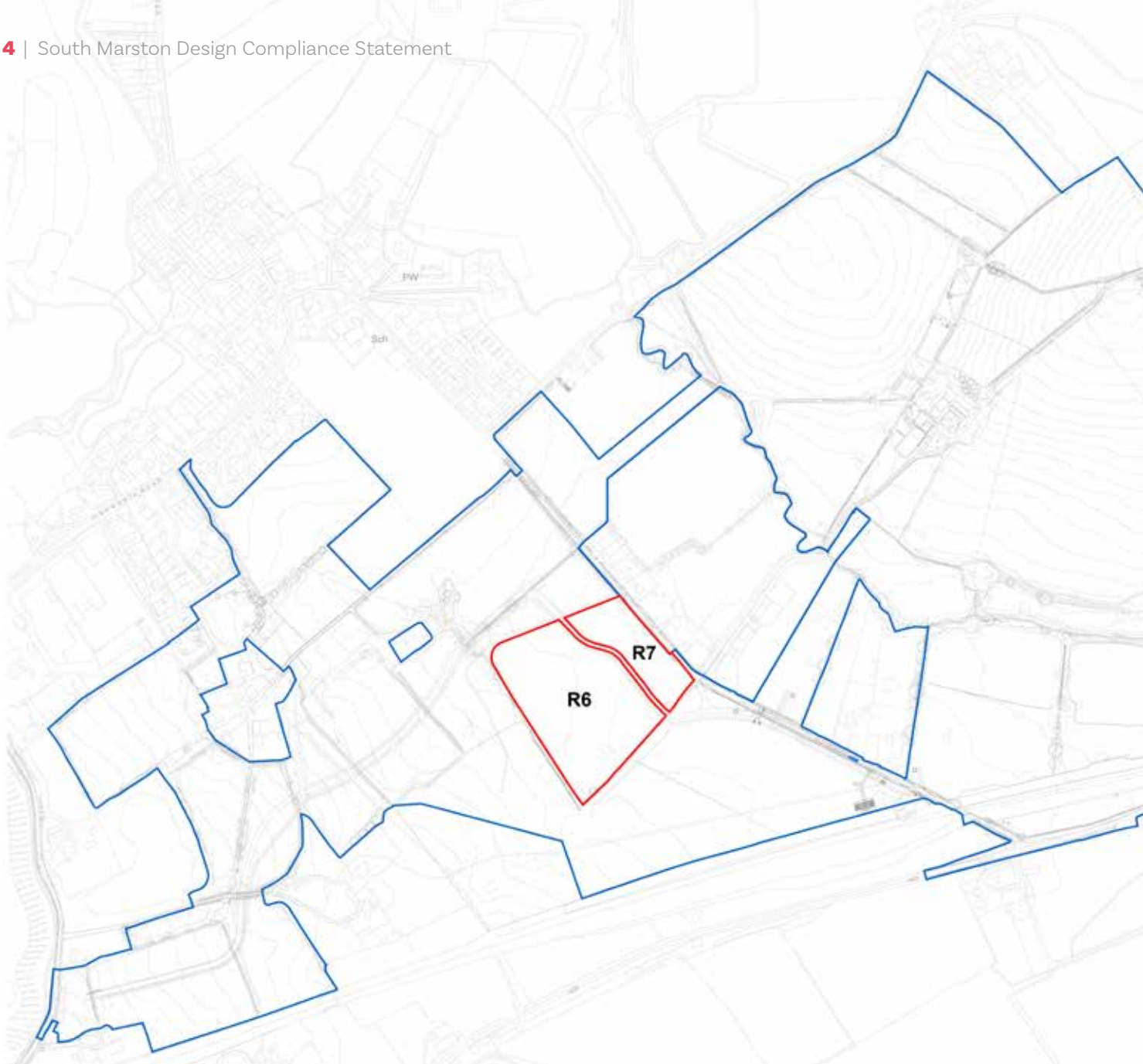
Desk Top Publishing and Graphic Design by Stantec Graphic Communication

This artwork was printed on paper using fibre sourced from sustainable plantation wood from suppliers who practice sustainable management of forests in line with strict international standards. Pulp used in its manufacture is also Elemental Chlorine Free (ECF).

© The contents of this document must not be copied or reproduced in whole or in part without the written consent of Stantec.

Date: 11.10.24 **Status:** Draft **Rev:** A03

Authors: RM **Checked by:** AA **Approved by:** AA

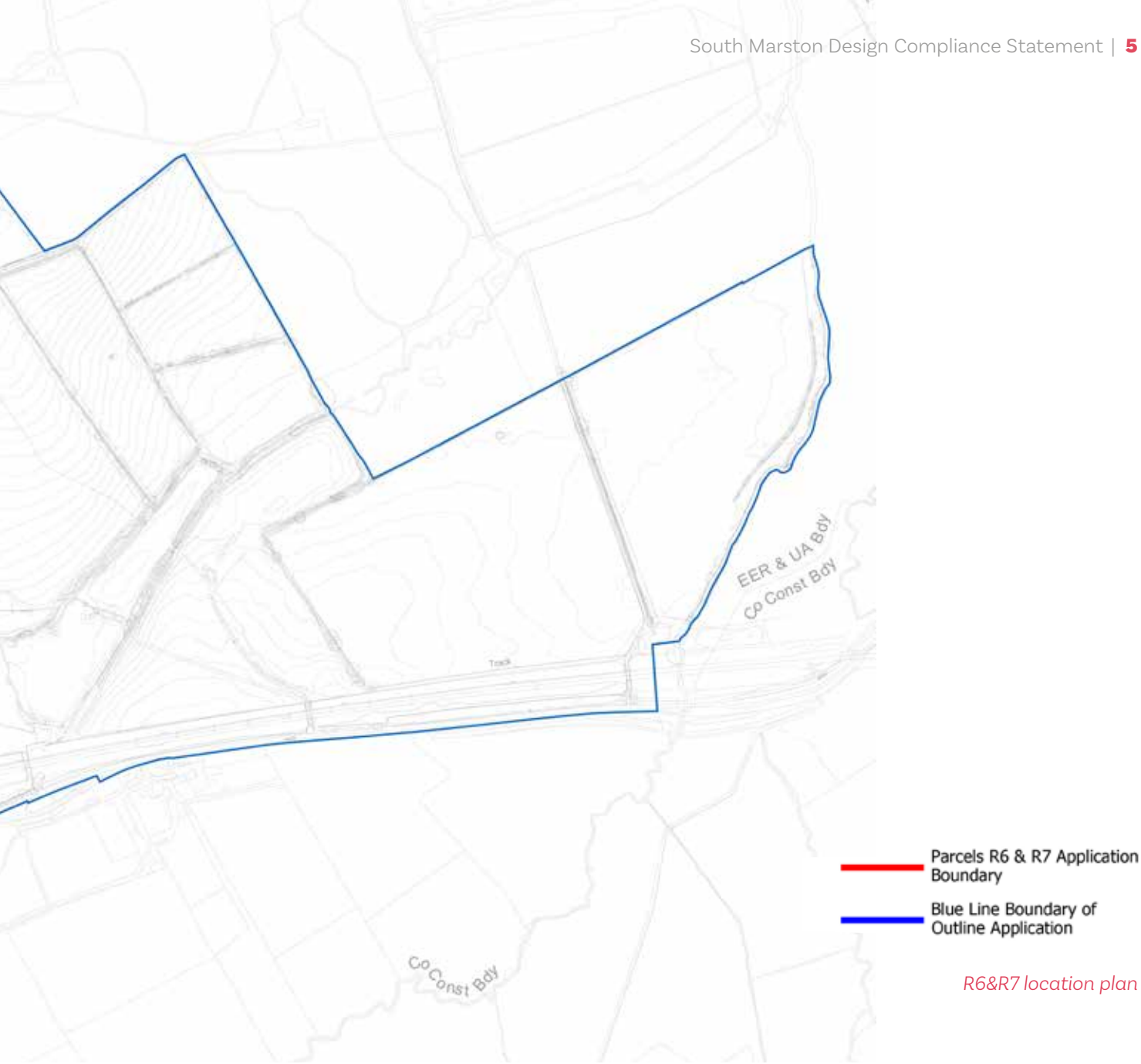


1 Introduction

This Design Compliance Statement (DCS) has been prepared by Stantec on behalf of Vistry Homes in support of the Reserved Matters submission for residential development at Parcels R6 & R7 at South Marston, Swindon.

This DCS explains the development proposals in a concise and structured manner and sets out how the Reserved Matters proposals for 137 dwellings, associated highways and landscape accord with Regulating Documents as set out in the approved Strategic Design Code for South Marston Expansion and Rowborough Village, dated May 2024.

Furthermore this document aligns with the approved Character Area Design Code for Marston Gate and Nightingale Corner dated July 2024.



R6&R7 location plan

2 Regulating Documents

This DCS is prepared in accordance with the Strategic Design Code (SDC) and supporting Mandatory Coding Plans for "South Marston & Rowborough Village."

The DCS accords with the following which are Approved by the Outline Planning Permission ref: S/OUT/13/1555/EDSN:

- Location Plan
- Proposed Highways Layout
- Highway Access & Improvement Works
- Illustrative Masterplan
- Development Framework Plan

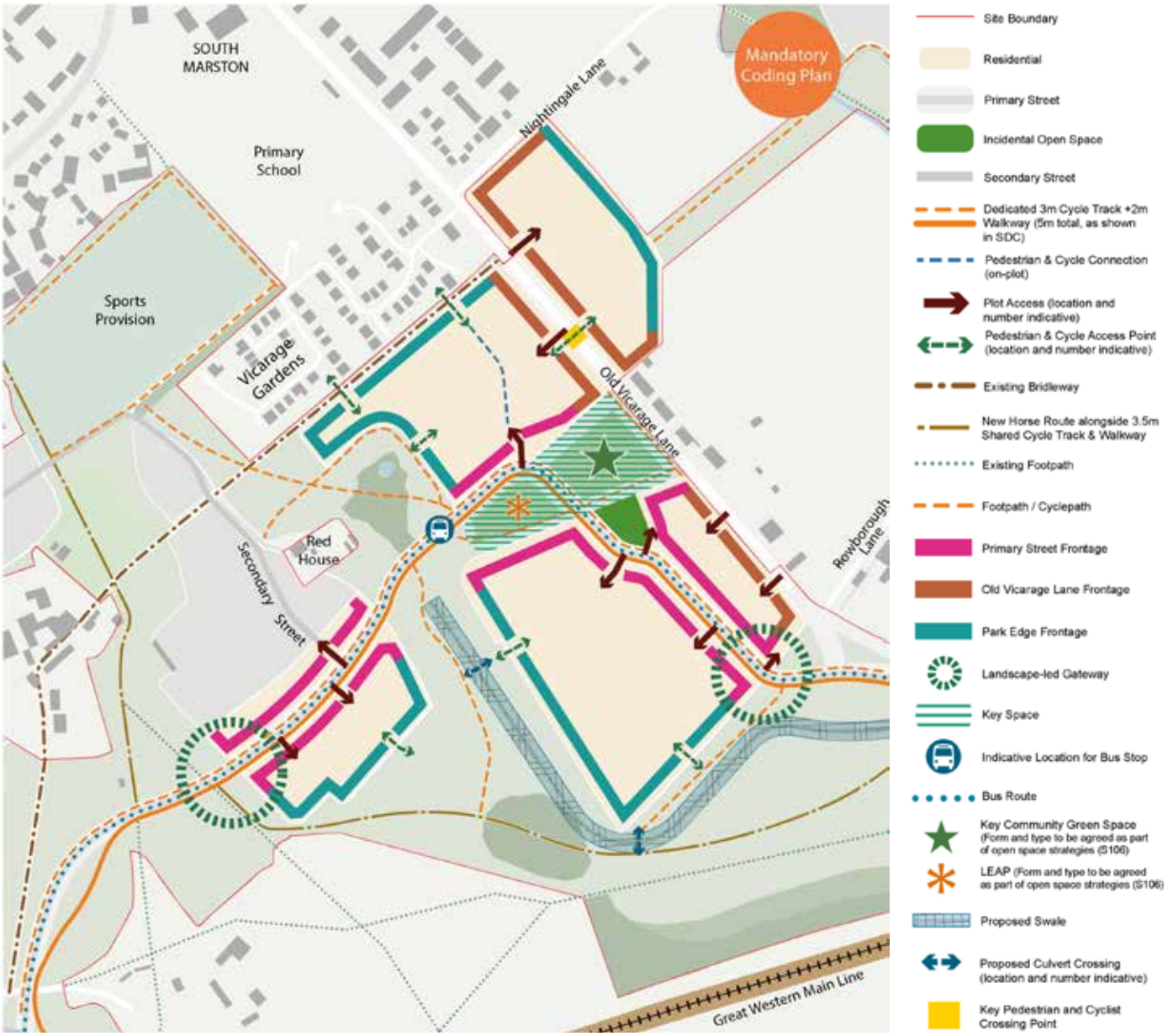
The Approved Mandatory Coding Plans in the SDC are as follows:

- Strategic Coding Plan
- Open Space Coding Plan
- Open Space Referencing Plan
- Land Use and Built Form Coding Plan
- Character Areas Coding Plan

3 Design Parameters

The SDC helpfully sets out details covering general matters for the proposed development at Parcels R6 & R7 in the Regulating Plan.

These can be summarised under the headings of Land Use, Access and Movement, Density, Building Heights, Frontages & Character Areas & Key Spaces. These parameters will be explored in the next section and will set the foundation for our design response for these parcels.



Regulating Plan

Land Use

Land use across these parcels is identified as residential development. Substantial elements of public green space, community orchard and play space surround these parcels but are outside of the red line boundary for this planning application.

Application Boundary Residential

Land Use Plan

Access & Movement

Access to these parcels is provided by the Primary Street proposed from the north and south of the parcels. This route is diverted off Old Vicarage Lane to serve the site and back onto Old Vicarage Lane for access to parcel R7 and the parcels R8 & R9 to the north of this Vistry Homes application. The Primary Street divides parcels R6 & R7 and continues through the Rowborough Village development to serve all subsequent residential development and reconnect with Thornhill Road to the west.

As set out in the Design Code there will be minimal vehicular access across the verge along the Primary Street and limited access to the proposed dwellings on Old Vicarage Lane.

The majority of dwellings within parcels R6 & R7 are served internally from either Tertiary Streets or Private Drives.

However further to consultation with Swindon Borough Council statutory consultees we have now included a Mews Street and a Shared Surface Street to improve road user's access.

Application Boundary
Primary Street
Tertiary Street
Shared Surface Street
Mews Street
Private Drive

Street Hierarchy Plan

Parking

The development will deliver a range of vehicle parking in accordance with Swindon Borough Council (SBC) Parking Standards in the form of:

- On plot parking (to rear and side);
- Grouped to side or front; and
- Rear parking courtyards (only to dwellings fronting the cycleway and verge side of the Primary Street).

Application Boundary
Residents Parking Space
Garage Parking
Visitor Parking

Parking Plan

Pedestrian & Cycle Movement

Strong pedestrian and cycling connections are provided throughout these parcels. There are multiple accesses into the surrounding green space and there will be a connection to the Northern POS linking onto the proposed Carpenters Walk route from the parcels above. These also provide connectivity to the surrounding green space, the Community Orchard and the LEAP in accordance with the SDC.

Application Boundary
Pedestrian Routes
Dedicated Cycle Route
Bus Route
Pedestrian Walking Distances

Pedestrian & Cycle Routes Plan

Density

These parcels are lower density as prescribed in the South Marston & Nightingale Corner Character Area within the SDC. The proposed density of less than 35 dph accord with the lower density requirement. Use of frontage parking or terraced dwellings within these parcels will be located centrally in development blocks and the edges will be the lowest density areas

Application Boundary Lower Density

Density Plan

Building Heights

The SDC allows for building heights across Parcels R6 & R7 to be 2 to 2.5 storey.

These parcels presently deliver 2 storey dwellings with varied roofscapes with larger, dual aspect dwellings positioned to respond to the Landscape Gateway at the southern entrance to the development.

Application Boundary | 2 Storey | 1 Storey

Building Heights Plan

Frontages

There are three frontage types defined for Parcels R6 & R7: Primary Street Frontage, Old Vicarage Lane Frontage and Parkland Edge Frontage onto Green Space. These are set out in the SDC and CADC.

Application Boundary
Primary Street Frontage
Old Vicarage Lane Frontage
Parkland Edge Frontage

Frontages Plan

Character Ares & Key Spaces

Parcels R6 & R7 are within the Marston Gate and Nightingale Corner Character Area. The proposals include a key space at their northern boundary and a Landscape-Led Gateway entrance gateway in accordance with the SDC & CADC.

This application is adjacent to Open Space, a Community Orchard and a LEAP. However while these inform the character areas and key spaces, they are not within this application red line boundary and detailed design will follow as a separate application.

Our design will provide a sensitive response to the Old Vicarage Lane boundary and its location on the edge of South Marston by reflecting and respecting the local context.

Application Boundary
Marston Gate & Nightingale Corner
Community Orchard
Green Space
LEAP
Landscape-Led Gateway

Chracter Area and Key Spaces Plan

4 Detailed Design Response

The following section sets out the detail design proposals for the development. In drawing up the proposals, design guidance set out in the Framework Plans and Design Guidance document has been followed.

The Layout has been designed to create a high-quality and attractive residential environment and sensitive townscape. Features which apply to the layout are set out below:

- Built form represents a more traditional, lower scale development;
- Materials, building arrangement and scale help to create a strong architectural and urban design solution. In accordance with the CADC we have designed compliant frontages, elevational styles and dwelling types suitable to the South Marston and Nightingale Corner Character Area;
- The largest dwellings are located in areas defined as being suitable for key focal buildings. These buildings and buildings on vistas also provide additional architectural detailing. We have used large, detached dwellings on focal corners. The use of fully rendered units and occasional weatherboarding denote focal dwellings and the allocation of recon stone, red and buff brick reflect the existing materials palette;
- Parcels R6 & R7 both enjoy Key Formal green frontage, allowing for character change in response to landscape treatment, boundary treatment and building typologies. We have used hard boundary treatments to enhance the formal structure of the Primary Street. The Parkland Edge and Old Vicarage Lane boundary treatments are soft and in keeping with their positions on existing retained hedgerows or public open space;
- Key spaces with these parcels benefit from enhanced landscape led areas; existing hedgerow and tree planting will be retained and enhanced along boundaries in accordance with the landscape enhancement strategies approved in the SDC;
- Use of semi-detached house types to create structure and rhythm to the non-verge side of the Primary Streets in accordance with the SDC. Use of detached house types to create more continuous frontage with varied roofscapes to the verge side of the Primary Streets and reduce vehicular access to a minimum with rear parking courtyards in accordance with the SDC;
- Use of varied architectural brick detailing will define frontage characters.
- Varied porch and roof styles to improve placemaking and reflect the local style
- A Mews Street has now been introduced to allow for improved resident vehicular and pedestrian access. The Mews will lead onto a Shared Surface Street that opens to the POS and has access to multiple visitors parking spaces thereby allowing easy access from the edge to the centre of Parcel R6.
- Frontage parking with increased landscape buffers to enable significant tree planting to Tertiary Streets and Mews Street
- Legible pedestrian links through parcels allow for easy movement across Parcels R6 & R7 with focal tree planting to act as wayfinding.
- Traffic calming on straight roads introduced in the form of landscaping build outs which also form vistas to the north-south Tertiary streets. Therse vistas are also emphasised with alternative roof configurations and public/private space defined with hard boundary treatments.
- On plot parking is provided either to side of dwellings or in short runs to fronts of dwellings, interspersed regularly with landscape to avoid large expanses of hard surfacing in accordance with the SDC;
- Strong development frontage along the Parkland Edge, with detached dwellings varying in accesses and roofscapes creating a more organic built form with landscaped front gardens and varied boundary treatments;
- Dual aspect frontage onto the key spaces throughout both Parcels R6 & R7;
- Development fronts onto the Old Vicarage Lane boundary on Parcel R7, set back by private drive access, new dedicated link pedestrian footway and the retained existing hedgerow in accordance with the SDC;

- Larger detached dwellings to the edges of both Parcels R6 & R7, with semi-detached and occasional terraces to the Primary Street Frontage and within the interior of Parcel R6 in accordance with the SDC. This is to create more continuous frontage to the Primary Street and maintain the more organic detached edge to the parcels;
- Tenure blind affordable housing provided;
- Provision of M4(3) compliant dwellings as part of the affordable provision.

Proposed Site Layout

Appearance

This section details the use of materials and architectural detailing used to create attractive and varied development in Parcel R6 & R7.

Dwellings in vista or key positions are dual aspect and corner turning dwellings are used to minimise blank gable elevations. Ground floor bay windows feature on several dwelling types to increase variation in build lines and enhance corner dwellings.

The proposed built form reflects the building line and built form in accordance with the CADC. Large, detached homes, occasional semi-detached and short terraced homes with hipped roofs, gable roofs and bay windows reflect the variety of house designs in the area and in accordance with the CADC. Boundary treatments are also in accordance with the SDC and CADC with hedgerows and occasional railings to define private frontages. 1.8m high brick walls screen private rear gardens fronting the public realm. The existing vegetation to be retained on site forms a strong edge to the character of the development and, together with the proposed landscape design will help integrate the built form into the local context.

Parcels R6 & R7 share common appearance palettes, both being in the same character area. The Primary Street bisects the two parcels and leads towards Parcels 8 & 9 to the north. The SDC shows the Primary Street has an entrance arrival key space, which will have larger focal buildings at the gateway and will be defined by the landscape-led design and proposed and retained trees at this location as set out in the SDC.

OVL Detailing:
Band courses to recon stone dwellings and plinths to render swellings have been included along this frontage.

The Primary Street has a 2m footpath, segregated 3m cycleway and a 2.5m verge to the east and 2m footpath to the west in accordance with the SDC & CADC. The verge allows for visitor parking and formal tree planting creating a strong avenue bisecting the two development parcels and reducing the impact of the extended hard landscaping in this area in accordance with the SDC & CADC.

Parkland Edge Street Scene

Parkland Edge Detailing:
Brick detailing to ground floor. Weather boarding to first floor. Variation of front door colours from a heritage range. Chimneys on key buildings.

Primary Street Detailing:
Brick detailing to ground floor. Variation of roof and porch form to create interest and definition in semi-detached dwellings

Materials

The materials palette reflects the requirements set out in the CADC, with fully render dwellings used to frame the north and south viewpoints at Old Vicarage Lane. Red brick is the predominant external wall material but recon stone is used to the Old Vicarage Lane frontage and buff brick defines the verge side of the Primary Street and is used occasionally on the Parkland Frontage to emphasize the create variation. Weatherboarding to the first floor is also used to reflect local detailing as set out in the CADC. Smooth grey and terracotta roof tiles are used throughout the development. Heritage colour front doors will be interspersed with white through the development to increase distinction between character areas and promote placemaking. Windows will be finished in white.

Fenestrations & Detailing

- Dark Weatherboarding to Focal Units;
- Front doors are a range of heritage colours and white;
- Windows are white uPVC;
- Porch detailing to match windows;
- Eaves and barge boards are white.

As set out in the CADC. The architectural materials include a palette of:

Walls

Ibstock Aston Weathered Buff Brick

Ibstock Aston Weathered Red Brick

Bekstone Buff Black Recon Stone

Weberpral M Render. Colour Chalk. To focal buildings

Dark Grey Weatherboarding

Roofs

Russell Galloway Slate Grey Tile;

Russell Galloway Terracotta Tile

Access, Street Design & Parking

In accordance with the approved Development Framework Plan set out in the SDC and the CADC. The streets connect to create a legible and permeable network and character, the identity of the street types will assist in developing a sense of place as well as enhancing legibility.

The street types all comply with the SDC and the CADC as follows:

Primary Street:

The Primary Street comprises a 6.75m Carriageway with 2m footpaths on both sides and a dedicated 3m cycleway and 2.5m verge on the eastern side

Tertiary Street

Tertiary Streets are 5m carriageways with 2m footpath either side

Private Drives

Private drives are used to the edge of development and to minimise direct access onto Old Vicarage Lane. These are provided at 3.7m - 4.1m with compliant turning room for resident parking and fire appliances where necessary.

Existing Road (Old Vicarage Lane)

The proposed link junction to Old Vicarage Lane is covered in a separate application. Our proposed accesses to R7 are consistent with the SDC & CADC which state access to dwellings in this parcel should be from private drives not directly onto OVL. We have minimised the number of accesses benefiting the existing road and the retention of the existing hedgerow to this boundary.

Shared Surface & Mews Street

These street types have been included in revised plans as a result of discussions with Highways Officers at Swindon Borough Council and are both proposed at 7m overall made up of a 6m carriageway and 1m footway.

Recycling & Refuse

Where homes are served by private drives, recycling and refuse collection points have been incorporated into the design where distances to homes exceed the 10m for operatives or 30m maximum distance for residents set out in the Wiltshire Council Draft Supplementary Planning Document. Waste storage and collection: guidance for developers. Version January 2016.

Safety & Security

Safety and security are vital elements in any urban development.

It is therefore important to maximise the potential for natural surveillance within the scheme. This not only reduces the opportunities for crime, but it also reduces the fear of crime, as users tend to feel more at ease. This can help to promote activity on routes and contribute to creating a sense of place and community.

There are essentially three key design principles for designing safety into the public realm and we have reflected these in our proposals. These include:

Ensuring natural surveillance and human presence:

This is achieved by fronting onto the public realm, minimising blank walls and facades and adding windows from habitable rooms to overlook parking courts.

Minimising conflict:

This is achieved by providing safe routes and crossing points for pedestrians and cyclists. The 3m dedicated cycleway within the Primary Street allows for pedestrians and cyclists to have priority over vehicles.

Community involvement:

When people view spaces as their own they begin to take responsibility for them. The design of the layout presents a clear definition between public and private space. The public spaces including the Community Orchard and LEAP to the north of these parcels will be designed with the purpose of involving the community.

Primary Street Street Scene

Inclusiveness & Adaptability

The proposed development provides good access for all users to the houses and spaces, as well as through the development by delivering the following:

- Provide a range of different house types, tenure and sizes to create a mixed and inclusive development.
- Provide architectural design and detailing which ensures all houses are tenure blind;
- Provide a permeable scheme which integrates with the surrounding residential development through footpath and vehicle links.
- All affordable housing is NDSS complaint and 3% of the overall application is M4(3) compliant in accordance with the Policy HA3 (Wheelchair Accessible Housing) of the Local Plan.

5 Conclusion

The residential development at Parcels R6 & R7, South Marston has been designed on the basis of robust urban design principles, informed through an analysis of the site and surrounding area and in accordance with the SCD and the CADC. These parcels will make a positive and attractive contribution to the character of the wider development. Careful consideration of connections legibility, block structure, street hierarchy and exciting proposed green public and private open spaces will create a development with a strong character and sense of place.

This document has shown how this application responds to the design criteria set out in the approved SDC and CADC and provides the opportunity to develop a high-quality and attractive residential environment which follows current best practice development and urban design principles.